Md Al Amin

(Updated November 1, 2026)

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Education

- **University of Georgia**, Athens, GA — **Aug 2023 – Present**
  Ph.D. Candidate in Agricultural and Applied Economics — **Expected [May 2027]**
  - *Dissertation:* "Nutrition Assistance Programs, Food Security, and Diet Quality in the United States"
  - *Relevant Coursework:* Consumer Demand Theory; Causal Inference and Machine Learning for Economic Applications; Experimental and Behavioral Economics
- **Ohio University**, Athens, OH — **Aug 2022 – Aug 2023**
  M.A. in Applied Economics
- **University of Barishal**, Barishal, Bangladesh — **Jan 2015 – Dec 2018**
  B.S.S. in Economics

Research Interests

Health Economics, Environmental Economics, Development Economics

Job Market Paper

WIC Redemptions, Household Food Security, and the Quality of Food Acquisitions [Full Paper]

Abstract: We estimate the associations between participation in the Special Supplemental Program for Women, Infants, and Children (WIC), household diet quality, and food security using the National Household Food Acquisition and Purchase Survey (FoodAPS) and augmented inverse probability weighting (AIPW). Diet quality is measured using the Healthy Eating Index (HEI)-2010, while food security is measured using a binary food insecurity indicator. We find that redeeming WIC benefits is associated with significantly higher diet quality relative to WIC-eligible nonparticipants, with improvements concentrated in fruit, whole grains, dairy, protein foods, seafood, and plant proteins. In contrast, WIC participation is not associated with statistically significant improvements in household food security. These findings suggest that maximizing WIC benefit redemption, rather than simply increasing program enrollment, may generate greater nutritional benefits for participating households.

Publications

Journal Articles

1. Salah Uddin, Muhammad, Rashed Jahangir, Md Al Amin, and Muhammad Hassan Abbas. "Green Energy and the Shadow Economy: Implications for Environmental Sustainability in G7 Countries." Frontiers in Environmental Science 14 (2026): 1871821.
2. Salah Uddin, Muhammad, Abu Obyda, Md Roknuzzaman, and Md Al Amin. "From resource dependency to sustainability: The role of green energy, environmental policy, and innovation on green growth in BRICS." Energy for Sustainable Development 95 (2026): 102103.
3. Salah Uddin, Muhammad, Mohammad Ismayl Al Masud, Md Roknuzzaman, Mohammad Ahsan Habib, and Md Al Amin. "Does the informal economy undermine political stability? Empirical evidence from global perspectives." Economics of Governance 27, no. 1 (2026): 32.
4. Salah Uddin, Muhammad, Rashed Jahangir, Mamunur Rashid, Muhammad Hassan Abbas, and Md Al Amin. "The Role of Fintech and the Shadow Economy in Advancing Sustainable Development Across G7 Countries: Evidence From MMQR Analysis." Sustainable Development (2026).

5. Siddik, Md Abu Bakkar, Shah Jalal Ahmed, Md Zahid Hasan, Abdulla Al Masud, Md Yeasin Arafat, Md Jane Alam, Akher Ali, Muhammd Mustafiz, Md Al Amin, and Mahedi Hasan. "Relationship between body mass index, eating disorders, internet addiction, and social media addictions among adolescents in Bangladesh." Public Health Challenges 4, no. 4 (2025): e70142.

6. Amin, Md Al, and Md Tanvir Ahmed. "Beachgoers' Knowledge, Perceptions, and Willingness to Pay for Sustainable Waste Management in Kuakata Sea Beach, Bangladesh." Nature Environment & Pollution Technology 23, no. 2 (2024).

7. Chamuah, Suchibrata, Kiran, Divyashree N, Md Al Amin, Nazmin Sultana, Narendra Nath Hansda, Harish B M and Kohima Noopur. "Protected vegetable crop production for long-term sustainable food security." Journal of Scientific Research and Reports 30, no. 5 (2024): 660–669.

8. Rahat, K. M. R., Md Al Amin, and Md Tanvir Ahmed. "Comparing tourists' travel cost and consumer surplus to estimate the recreational values of Kuakata Sea Beach in Bangladesh." J Tourism Hospit 13, no. 1 (2024): 1-7.

9. Ahmed, Md Tanvir, and Md Al Amin. "Perilous Resurgence of Dengue Fever in Bangladesh: Gender Based Perspectives on Risk Perception and Adaptation Strategies." Universal Journal of Public Health 11, no. 5 (2023): 751-760.

Accepted

1. "The Impact of Energy Efficiency and Conservation Master Plan on Primary Energy Consumption in Bangladesh," with Md Roknuzzaman, Energy Nexus (accepted September 2026)

Working Papers (Dissertation Chapters)

1. "WIC Redemptions, Household Food Security, and the Quality of Food Acquisitions," with Travis A. Smith

2. "How Would Changes to Community Eligibility Provision Thresholds Affect Child Diet Quality?" with Travis A. Smith

3. "Measuring the Distance to Food Sufficiency: A Continuous Approach to Food Hardship," with Travis A. Smith

Work Experience

- **Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Georgia 05/2025 – Present
  - Conducted research under the supervision of Dr. Travis A. Smith on the project titled *"The Effects of Medicaid, SNAP, and Dual Enrollment on Food Insecurity"* (Proposal ID: 122608).
  - Extracted, cleaned, and merged Food Security Supplement (FSS) and Annual Social and Economic Supplement (ASES) datasets from the Current Population Survey (CPS).
- **Teaching Assistant**, University of Georgia 01/2026 – 05/2026
  - Assisted Dr. Travis A. Smith with *AAEC 3600: Economics of Food Policy* for a second semester and conducted weekly review sessions to help students with lecture materials and problem sets.
  - Graded assignments and exams and provided feedback to strengthen students' understanding of food policy economics.
- **Teaching Assistant**, University of Georgia 01/2025 – 05/2025
  - Assisted Dr. Travis A. Smith with *AAEC 3600: Economics of Food Policy* and conducted weekly review sessions to help students with lecture materials and problem sets.
  - Graded assignments and exams and provided feedback to strengthen students' understanding of food policy economics.
- **Teaching Assistant**, University of Georgia 08/2024 – 12/2024
  - Assisted Dr. Genti Kostandini with *AAEC 3690: Agribusiness Finance* and held weekly lab sessions and office hours to guide students through problem-solving and Microsoft Excel-based financial analysis.

- Helped design and grade homework, lab assignments, and exams and provided feedback to support student learning.

- **Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Georgia 06/2024 – 08/2024
  - Collaborated with Professor Greg Colson on a sensitive project compiling faculty data, publications, titles, and publicly available salaries across multiple universities.
  - Collected, verified, and updated faculty information using departmental websites, CVs, and publication records, ensuring data accuracy and completeness for reports to the CAES Deans, UGA Provost, and UGA President.
- **Graduate Research Assistant**, University of Georgia 08/2023 – 05/2024
  - Assisted Dr. Yukiko Hashida and Dr. Suhyun Jung on the project *"Conservation Reserve Program that Changes Farmers' Labor Allocation, Land Use/Cover, and Local Welfare in the U.S."* by combining and analyzing USDA CRP, Census of Agriculture, and American Community Survey data.
  - Generated descriptive statistics on CRP enrollment trends and evaluated the mechanisms underlying the program's effects on farmers and local communities.
- **Teaching Assistant**, Ohio University 08/2022 – 05/2023
  - Assisted Dr. Cortney Rodet with *Introductory Statistics (MATH 1500)* for two semesters by leading recitation sessions and holding office hours to explain statistical concepts and answer students' questions.
  - Graded assignments and exams and provided constructive feedback to support student learning.
- **Graduate Assistant**, Ohio University 01/2023 – 05/2023
  - **Course Support – Intermediate Microeconomics**: Collaborated with Dr. Daniel Karney to prepare lecture materials and supplemental content, streamlining course delivery and enhancing learning resources for over 120 undergraduate students.
  - **Research Assistance – Economics Projects**: Assisted Dr. Roberto Duncan in literature review, data collection, and preliminary analysis, contributing to actionable insights and supporting progress on multiple research studies.
- **Instructor and Tutor**, Bangladesh 2019 – 2022
  - Independently taught mathematics (2019–2020) and Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics (2021–2022), preparing regular quizzes and examinations.
  - Tutored undergraduate students in economics, mathematics, and statistics.

Conference Papers

1. Presenter, "How Would Changes to Community Eligibility Provision Thresholds Affect Child Diet Quality?" Agricultural and Applied Economic Association, Kansas City, Missouri, July 2026.
2. Presenter, "WIC Redemptions, Household Food Security, and the Quality of Food Acquisition," AAEA & WAEA Annual Meeting, Denver, Colorado, July 2025.
3. Presenter, "Measuring the Distance to Food Sufficiency: A Continuous Approach to Food Hardship," Southern Economic Association, Houston, Texas, November 2026 (Accepted).

Grants, Honors, and Awards

- **CAES J. Mark and Judy Mobley Graduate Fellowship**, University of Georgia 2026
- **Travel Grant Award**, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting 2026
  - Competitively selected to present research at a leading international conference, recognizing the significance and policy relevance of the work

- **Travel Grant Award**, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting 2025
  - Awarded competitive funding based on research quality and contribution to applied economic and policy analysis
- **Faculty Dean Award**, University of Barishal, Bangladesh 2022
  - Awarded competitively in recognition of outstanding academic performance and distinction among top-performing students
- **B.S.S Merit Scholarship**, Porijon Inc., Sylhet, Bangladesh 2015–2018
  - Merit-based scholarship awarded through competitive selection based on sustained academic excellence

References

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